

Version: 1.0

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Approved By: Management Team, Berkshire Care Staffing

Safeguarding Policy

1.1 Purpose

Berkshire Care Staffing Ltd is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare, dignity, rights, and wellbeing of all vulnerable adults, children, clients, service users, and staff.

This policy ensures compliance with:

- The Care Act 2014
- Safeguarding Vulnerable Groups Act 2006
- Children Act 1989 & 2004
- Mental Capacity Act 2005
- Working Together to Safeguard Children guidance
- CQC Fundamental Standards

1.2 Scope

This policy applies to:

- Employees
- Agency workers
- Contractors
- Volunteers
- Directors and management

1.3 Definitions of Abuse

Abuse may include:

- Physical abuse
- Emotional or psychological abuse
- Sexual abuse
- Financial abuse
- Neglect or acts of omission
- Discriminatory abuse
- Domestic abuse

- Modern slavery
- Organizational abuse
- Self-neglect

1.4 Responsibilities

All staff must:

- Safeguard service users at all times
- Report concerns immediately
- Maintain professional boundaries
- Attend safeguarding training
- Cooperate with investigations

Managers must:

- Ensure safeguarding concerns are investigated promptly
- Notify local authorities and relevant bodies where required
- Maintain accurate records
- Support staff during safeguarding processes

1.5 Reporting Procedure

Any safeguarding concern must be reported immediately to: 1. Line Manager 2. Safeguarding Lead 3. Local Authority Safeguarding Team (if required) 4. Police or emergency services where immediate danger exists

All incidents must be documented in writing.

1.6 Whistleblowing

Staff are encouraged to report unsafe practice without fear of victimization.

1.7 Confidentiality

Information relating to safeguarding concerns will only be shared on a need-to-know basis and in accordance with GDPR.
